

US equities slip as yields rise, VIX spikes

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The major indices closed lower on Friday, with the **S&P 500** down **-0.76%** to 7,706.03 and the Dow Jones off **-1.03%** at 51,511.59. The VIX surged **+2.08%** to 15.18, reflecting heightened volatility as the 10-year Treasury yield climbed to 5.11%, up **+3.04%** on the day.

Technology lagged, led by a **-1.47%** pullback in **NVDA**, while defensive sectors showed modest gains. Investors remain focused on upcoming earnings and the Fed's policy outlook.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,706.03	-0.76%	
Dow Jones	51,511.59	-1.03%	
Nasdaq 100	30,470.29	-0.04%	
Russell 2000	2,838.66	-1.28%	
VIX	15.18	+2.08%	
10-yr Yield	5.11%	+3.04%	
WTI Crude	92.13	-0.03%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
META	744.10	+1.02%
MSFT	500.59	+0.52%
TSLA	380.12	+0.32%
NVDA	225.51	-1.47%
AMZN	249.27	-2.24%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Company	NVDA
Q3 EPS	\$3.12
Revenue	\$8.1 bn
YoY Growth	+22%
Guidance	-5% YoY

NVDA missed consensus EPS, prompting a **-1.47%** slide, while its revenue still beat expectations. The downward guidance for FY2027 has heightened risk aversion in the tech sector.

Macro & Fed

- Fed policy rate: 5.25%-5.50% (unchanged)
- 10-yr Treasury yield: 5.11% (+3.04%)
- Key data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PCE 03:30, Existing-home sales 04:45

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions remain elevated, pressuring oil-related ETFs (XLE **+0.96%**).
- China's manufacturing PMI posted a surprise rebound at 51.2, supporting risk-on sentiment.
- Eurozone inflation eases to 2.3%, nudging the EUR/USD toward 1.075.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
09:30 Sep 25	AAPL	iPhone 17 launch impact
10:00 Sep 25	GOOGL	Ad-tech revenue trend
11:15 Sep 25	JPM	Net interest income margin
12:00 Sep 25	XOM	Oil price sensitivity

Stocks worth watching

- **AMD** – upside potential if Q4 graphics revenue beats estimates.
- **V** – dividend yield at 7.2% amid rising rates.
- **CRM** – strong SaaS renewal rates could offset broader tech weakness.
- **CVX** – benefit from higher crude prices and XLE rally.
- **BABA** – rebound in Chinese e-commerce could spark a rally.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Further 10-yr yield rise above 5.20%.
- NVDA guidance miss triggers tech sell-off.
- Escalation in Middle-East conflict.

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Better-than-expected CPI showing inflation cooling.
- Strong earnings from **AAPL** or **MSFT**.
- Positive Chinese PMI data sustaining risk appetite.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Market Data

SEC — Company Filings

Trading Economics — CPI

Federal Reserve — Policy Rate